CAREER GLITCH · SHORT · SIMPLE · NO BORING PARTS

DANCE INSTRUCTOR IN THE AI ERA

Video tutorials are free and endless. People still pay to be in a room where someone fixes their two left feet, live.

★ **TL;DR — Teaching dance at a ~$45K median, startable in 1–6 months if you can already dance — no license, no gatekeeper. The catch: evenings, weekends, and a body that is the equipment.** ★

THE CAREER GLITCH TAKE

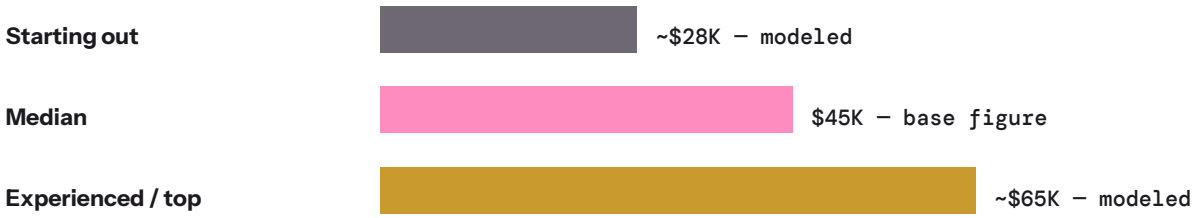
OUR TAKE: YES — WITH EYES OPEN

MEDIAN ~$45K · TRAINING 1-6 months · AI RISK LOW

- Screens teach steps; only a person in the room corrects posture, timing and confidence.
- The barrier is skill, not paper: if you can dance and explain, you can be hired.
- It's a portfolio income — classes, privates and events stitched together by reputation.

The site's take, built from this profession's numbers in the Career Glitch base.

THE MONEY — LOOK AT THE BARS



The Career Glitch base figure for Dance Instructor is a ~$45K median (compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). The starting and top bars are modeled around that median — orientation, not a promise. Pay swings hard by state, employer and experience: check live postings in your state before planning around any number.

WHAT DOES A DANCE INSTRUCTOR ACTUALLY DO?

- ✓ Teaching group classes and breaking down choreography

- ✓ Private lessons, including wedding first dances
- ✓ Preparing music, routines and showcase pieces
- ✓ Studio admin, scheduling and promoting your classes

Think: a fitness coach and an entertainer wearing one pair of shoes.

WHAT AI ALREADY TOOK (AND WHAT IT CAN'T)

THE ROBOT	THE HUMAN
Practice videos, music editing and booking tools automate the edges of the job. Apps will happily drill your students between classes — your classes.	Correcting a body in real time, reading a room's energy, and partnering people through steps they've been scared of for years. Presence is the lesson.

⚠ **Your knees, feet and back are your capital. One injury is an unpaid vacation, and nobody's covering your sick days.**

THE VIBE — IS THIS YOUR LIFE?

THE JOB IS	THE JOB IS NOT
✓ Music and movement all day ✓ Joyful rooms — people come to be happy ✓ Evenings that feel like events, not shifts	✗ A night-and-weekend schedule by definition ✗ Physical wear that accumulates quietly ✗ Patchy income until classes fill

Good fit? A real dancer with teaching patience and performer's energy.
Bad fit? Your body is already complaining, or you need a salaried, daytime, seated life.

THE FORK — PICK ONE DOOR

DOOR A — TEACH AT AN ESTABLISHED STUDIO	DOOR B — INDEPENDENT INSTRUCTOR
Studios bring the students, the floor and the schedule. You audition, assist or sub first, then earn regular slots. The per-hour reality is modest; the consistency is the point.	Rent floor time, run your own classes and privates, and build a following under your own name. More risk and more admin — and every student relationship belongs to you.

Smart move: Wedding first-dance lessons are the premium niche hiding in plain sight: motivated clients, a hard deadline, and no interest in bargain hunting.
Where you land after: Senior instructor with full classes, then a studio of your own or a choreography-for-events practice.

YOUR ROADMAP — 6 STEPS

1	2	3	4	5	6
DEFINE WHAT	GET INSIDE	WIN A	ADD PRIVATE	BECOME VISIBLE	EXPAND DELIBERATEL

STEP 1 — Define what you teach

FREE · TODAY

- Pick the styles and levels you can teach well today
- Film a short demo of you teaching, not just dancing

STEP 2 — Get inside a studio

WEEKS 1-4

- Audition, assist or offer to substitute at local studios
- Learn each studio's class formats and student levels

STEP 3 — Win a regular slot

MONTHS 1-3

- Take any recurring class and make it the reliable one
- Learn names fast — retention is personality plus progress

STEP 4 — Add private lessons

MONTHS 2-4

- Offer privates for beginners, couples and wedding dances
- Price privates as the premium product they are

STEP 5 — Become visible

MONTHS 3-5

- Teach at showcases and studio events
- Post class clips and student progress with permission

STEP 6 — Expand deliberately

MONTHS 5-6

- Add a class, a level, or your own rented-floor session
- Track which hours actually pay and cut the rest

FIRST 90 DAYS — JUST DO THIS

- ☐ Today: film a two-minute clip of you teaching a simple sequence.
- ☐ Days 1–30: studio auditions and assistant or sub slots secured.
- ☐ Days 31–60: a weekly class with your name on the schedule.
- ☐ Days 61–90: first private and wedding-dance clients booked.
- ☐ Day 90: you're teaching every week, and students are arriving because of you.

NEXT — MAKE IT PERSONAL

This roadmap is the same for everyone. Your life is not.

- Not sure this career fits YOU? Take the Big Career Test — 50 questions, your top-3 matches and one honest “probably NOT you”. → careerglitch.com/#test
- Already sure? Turn AI into Your Personal Career Mentor — a 2,300-word system that interviews you first, checks your hours, budget and deadline honestly, and builds YOUR plan into a Notion dashboard. → careerglitch.com/#prompt

★ STEPS ARE FREE. CORRECTION ISN'T. ★

CAREER GLITCH · Figures: Career Glitch profession base (medians and training ranges compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). Modeled bars are estimates around the base median. License and certification rules vary by state — verify with your state board before paying for any program.